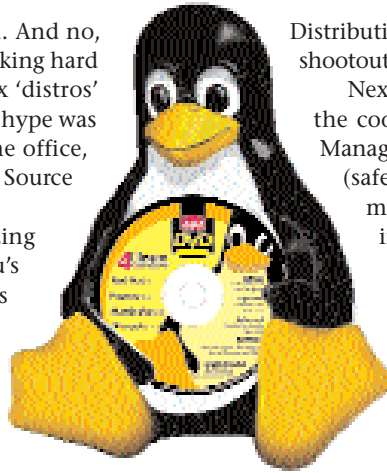


Tux Invasion

Digit suffered from penguin fever this month. And no, not from burning the midnight oil while working hard to collect 4.3 GB of the latest and best Linux 'distros' for you, but more from interest in learning what the hype was all about. With all the geekdom running around the office, talking Linux all day and shouting praises of 'Open Source ki jai', it was inevitable.

All throughout the month, people were buzzing around asking questions about Linux. The *nix guru's were the most sought after people, with followers hanging on to their every word when they gave their impromptu 'I-knew-Linux-was-the-best-all-along' sermons.

Even the writers team was bustling, with Aayush and Mouly arguing incessantly about whose Linux



Distribution was better—thankfully the Linux shootout in test drive put an end to that problem.

Next, everyone wanted to load Linux, as it was the cool thing to do. Prashant, the CRN Brand Manager installed SuSE, Sumod installed Xandros (safely, with VMware on Windows XP) and many other swear-by-Windows non-techie's installed various flavours of Linux.

All the hype, heated discussions and sermons apart, this month was a lot of fun with the penguin stampeding through the office. Let's hope things stay that way, as we do our bit to support the free OS movement. *Viva la Open Source!*

Digit's Hidden Hulks

Last month Nabjeet Ganguly (Consumer Marketing Manager), and the marketing team pulled off quite a coup by tying up with Paramount Pictures—the folks who make some real cool movies. Now if you have been following Digit (as you should have...) then you would have read about *The Hulk* contest last month in Digit (and seen the trailer on Playware). You can win free tickets to a screening of the soon-to-be released movie, and there's more-free holiday packages to exotic locations such as Kerala and Goa to be won!



Nabjeet is one of those guys who quietly pulls off some really cool deals like these. In his words, the "deal went through smoothly, since the movie is the sort that would appeal to all Digit readers", and now movie goes in ten of India's top Digit readership cities are going to see Digit logos and banners alongside the posters for *The Hulk*.

In fact, the trailers for the movie on the July Playware CD contain footage that has not been seen on any other Hulk trailers. But wait up, things are going to get all the more peachy. This month, Digit and Paramount Pictures are joining hands yet again for two much anticipated movies-2Fast 2Furious and Tomb Raider - The Cradle of Life. The Playware CDs again contain must-see high-action trailers from both the movies. And yes, there are contests galore. Digit readers now get to win 1,500 tickets for each movie—and vacation packages!

Now with the marketing team doing this, it was natural for just about everybody in Digit to demand a ticket. Since Nabjeet

hasn't come forth with tickets yet, wild rumours are abounding about how Nabjeet and his team are going to 'black' the tickets—but you didn't hear this from us!

The hunt is on...

Three months after the first talent hunt, the newbies are no longer that, and have settled in. When asked how they were doing, the results varied from, "Fabulous! Man" and "The high speed Internet rocks!", to "Can't talk now, got a game review to do" and "The only problem is that my parents miss me, and I feel guilty, because I don't!" They seemed to be fitting in just fine, between game... err... reviews and surfing the Internet for (Ahem!) research.

What we needed was some new faces around, especially because we needed some new people to rag. So up came Talent Hunt 2. This time the sales and marketing department wanted to hire... The procedure was planned and finally the test began. It was scheduled to run for 24 hours starting at 12 midnight on the twentieth.

Once again, the response was phenomenal, and the dedicated server we had set up to run the tests was bogged down by 11 am. Rakesh Tiwari our systems administrator had to rush to set up another server just to be able to handle the traffic. Throughout the day there were people logging on to take the 175-question test. At 1 am the next morning Rakesh and Anurag Gour (Head Client Marketing) told us that 2,500 individuals had logged on to try their luck for the first round of tests. Here's wishing all those who took part the very best of luck. With the second round of tests (for the 200 short-listed candidates) around the corner, we're sure to get the cream of an already impressive crop. Watch this space for updates. 